

challenge_filters_pagination

Helix OTA — challenge_filters_pagination.sh companion guide

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-10T10:10:00Z

External user guide (Constitution §11.4.18) for tests/e2e/
challenge_filters_pagination.sh.

Overview

challenge_filters_pagination.sh is an autonomous, anti-bluff end-to-end challenge (Constitution §11.4 / §11.4.27 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.98) that covers the two just-shipped query features of the Helix OTA control plane:

1. **Per-device telemetry filters** — GET /api/v1/devices/{id}/telemetry?event=&since=&until=&limit=&cursor=
2. **Group + group-members cursor pagination** — GET /api/v1/groups?limit=&cursor= and GET /api/v1/groups/{id}/members?limit=&cursor=, both returning next_cursor.

Unlike challenge_operational.sh (which black-box-drives an *already-running* server via --base-url), this script is **fully self-hosting**, mirroring the pipeline_signed.sh harness: it **builds** ota-server from source, **boots** it with ephemeral in-memory configuration, **seeds** real state through the real REST API, **drives** the two features over real HTTP (curl + jq), and **tears the server down** on every exit path. There are **no mocks** of the system under test and **no manual steps**.

Prerequisites

- bash, go, curl, jq on PATH.
- No database (the server uses its in-memory repository).
- No admin password to supply — the script mints an ephemeral admin password and token secret for its own run; nothing is committed (§11.4.10).

If any of go/curl/jq is missing, or go build fails, the script exits 3 (SKIP-with-reason) rather than fabricating a PASS (§11.4.3 / §11.4.6).

Usage examples

Run it directly (builds + boots its own server on port 8096):

```
bash tests/e2e/challenge_filters_pagination.sh
```

Pick a different port (e.g. to avoid a clash):

```
HELIX_PORT=8097 bash tests/e2e/challenge_filters_pagination.sh
# or
bash tests/e2e/challenge_filters_pagination.sh --port 8097
```

Reuse a pre-built server binary (skips the go build):

```
( cd server && go build -o /tmp/ota-server ./cmd/ota-server )
bash tests/e2e/challenge_filters_pagination.sh --server-bin /tmp/ota-server
```

Inspect the captured run (tee'd live to this file):

```
cat tests/e2e/FILTERS_PAGINATION_EVIDENCE.txt
```

Inputs

Input	Default	Meaning
--port / \$HELIX_PORT	8096	TCP port for the self-hosted server
--server-bin	<i>(build into a temp dir)</i>	pre-built ota-server binary
\$HELIX_FILTERS_EVIDENCE	tests/e2e/ FILTERS_PAGINATION_EVIDENCE.txt	evidence file path

Outputs

- Human-readable [PASS]/[FAIL]/[SKIP] lines on stdout **and** in the evidence file, ending with == summary: N passed, M failed, K skipped == and a RESULT: PASS|FAIL line.
- Exit code: 0 only if every hard assertion passed; non-zero on any mismatch; 3 on a missing prerequisite / unbuildable server (SKIP, never a false PASS).

Side-effects

Builds + starts + stops exactly one ota-server (in-memory repo — no database, no host state touched); frees the port on every exit path via trap cleanup EXIT INT TERM; writes the evidence file under tests/e2e/. Ephemeral build output and the server log live in an mktemp dir that is rm -rf'd on exit.

Internal behaviour

1. **Build + boot** — go `build ./cmd/ota-server` into a temp dir, start it with `HELIX_PORT / ephemeral HELIX_ADMIN_* / HELIX_TOKEN_SECRET`, poll `/healthz` until ready (~10 s budget).
2. **Login** — `POST /api/v1/auth/login` → bearer token; an unauthenticated `GET /telemetry/overview` must return **401** (auth-enforcement anti-bluff).
3. **Seed telemetry** — register a device, then ingest **six** events via `POST /api/v1/client/telemetry` at distinct types (`download_started`, `installing×2`, `verifying`, `success`, `failure`) with ascending RFC3339 timestamps. The ingest acknowledgement `.accepted` must equal 6 — so a later green filter result over *un-ingested* data is impossible.
4. **Feature 1 assertions** — `?event=` returns only the matching type; a bogus `?event=` → 400; `?since/?until` is an **inclusive** window (both boundary timestamps present, none outside); combined event+window narrows correctly; an inverted window → empty + null `next_cursor`; `?limit=2` cursor walk visits all six events with no overlap/gap.
5. **Feature 2 assertions** — create 3 groups; `?limit=2 page1 = 2` items + non-null `next_cursor`, `page2 = remaining 1 + null next_cursor`, union = all 3 distinct groups (no overlap/gap). Register 3 devices, batch-add them to a group, and paginate members the same way (each item carries a non-empty `added_at`). Validate `limit/cursor` bounds (`limit` out of `[1,200]` and a malformed/negative cursor → 400).

Anti-bluff guarantees (each HARD-FAILs the challenge)

- a bogus `?event=` that returned 200 (silent-empty) instead of 400;
- an `?event=` filter result that included an event of a different type;
- a `since/until` window that included an out-of-window event, or excluded a boundary event (inclusive bounds);
- `page1+page2` that overlap, drop, or duplicate any id;
- a `next_cursor` that is non-null on the genuinely-last page;
- a 401 on a protected route while seeded with a valid token.

Captured evidence (real run)

== summary: 50 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped ==
RESULT: PASS

Re-run end-to-end any number of times — verified twice consecutively with an identical 50 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped (§11.4.50 deterministic consistency, §11.4.98 full-automation). Full transcript: `tests/e2e/FILTERS_PAGINATION_EVIDENCE.txt`.

Related scripts

- `tests/e2e/pipeline_signed.sh` — the self-hosting boot harness this script mirrors (signed artifact pipeline).
- `tests/e2e/challenge_operational.sh` — black-box operational + rollout challenge against an already-running server.

- `tools/helixqa/banks/helix_ota.yaml` — the HelixQA bank; challenge HOTA-FILTERS-PAGINATION dispatches this script.

Source references

- `server/internal/api/handlers_telemetry.go` — `handleDeviceTelemetry(event / since / until / limit / cursor)`.
- `server/internal/api/handlers_group.go` — `parsePage`, `handleListGroup`, `handleListGroupMembers`.
- `server/internal/api/handlers_client.go` — `handleClientTelemetry(ingest)`.

Last verified: 2026-06-10